

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM | Detection Engineering | Security Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience implementing and maintaining robust security infrastructure, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, detection engineering and security operations. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I manage security across an 8,000-user hybrid environment, operating CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel as primary SIEM platforms, developing KQL-based detection rules and leading proactive threat hunting. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a high-ownership, infrastructure-first approach, working effectively within focused security teams to deliver measurable improvements in threat detection, incident response and vulnerability management across complex enterprise environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language), log ingestion and data connector configuration
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rule development, threat use case creation, alert tuning and false positive reduction
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development, automated alert triage, mean time to respond (MTTR) reduction
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security
- **Endpoint and Mobile Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, end-to-end incident case management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Implement and maintain robust security infrastructure across an 8,000-user hybrid environment, operating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel as primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms for enterprise-wide threat detection and monitoring
- Develop and optimise KQL-based detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel, building threat detection use cases aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve coverage across critical attack vectors including credential theft, lateral movement and persistence
- Lead proactive threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying advanced persistent threats (APTs) and indicators of compromise (IoCs) ahead of automated alerting thresholds
- Configure, tune and manage Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to streamline alert triage and accelerate mean time to respond (MTTR) across the security team
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, implementing and enforcing least-privilege access controls across enterprise systems and critical infrastructure components

- Manage Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, configuring Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) to secure identity across the full user population
- Drive vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus and Pentera BAS, translating scan findings into risk-prioritised remediation plans tracked to closure
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall policies and Mimecast email security platform, maintaining perimeter and messaging security controls across the hybrid infrastructure
- Deliver endpoint and mobile security management through Tanium and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, ensuring policy compliance and visibility across all managed endpoints
- Collaborate with IT infrastructure and business stakeholders to embed security controls and align the security programme to NIST CSF, CIS Controls and ISO 27001 frameworks

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored security alerts across SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and email security platforms, triaging and investigating incidents in line with documented response procedures
- Built and refined detection rules and monitoring use cases within SIEM platforms, improving threat visibility and reducing false positive alert volumes
- Contributed to identity security programme, supporting Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) access governance, access reviews and privileged access control implementation
- Supported vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking remediation progress against risk-prioritised vulnerability findings
- Assisted in developing and maintaining incident response playbooks, contributing to continuous improvement of the security operations function
- Delivered security awareness training and supported phishing simulation campaigns to strengthen human-layer security across the institution
- Maintained compliance alignment with ISO 27001, NIST CSF and Cyber Essentials Plus certification requirements

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering, quality assurance and infrastructure management within a fast-paced Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech environment, implementing security controls across cloud and on-premise systems
- Managed endpoint security and network access controls, enforcing consistent security policy compliance across all organisational endpoints
- Contributed to internal security audits, risk assessments and compliance activities, supporting the organisation's information security governance programme
- Provided IT infrastructure support, managing system configuration, patching and availability across the engineering and business user population

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users at UAL, delivering full endpoint visibility and detection coverage on time and within scope
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM as the primary SIEM platform, establishing a real-time detection and response capability across the hybrid infrastructure and replacing legacy tooling
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, materially reducing the privileged account attack surface and enforcing just-in-time access across critical systems
- Built SOAR-driven automated incident response playbooks, measurably reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-priority security incidents across the security operations team
- Developed a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, extending detection coverage across credential theft, lateral movement and persistence threat categories
- Contributed to the achievement and ongoing maintenance of Cyber Essentials Plus certification at UAL, validating baseline security controls across the institution

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 85,000 - 100,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)